

****Boredom of Power****

Charlie's Perspective

For a fleeting moment, I considered invoking **Authority**—that effortless, crushing force that could obliterate this half-vampire with a mere thought. His sneer, his arrogance, the way his eyes gleamed with misplaced confidence—it all begged for a swift, humiliating end. But where would the fun be in that? Killing without effort was as dull as watching paint dry.

“Come, challenger,” I said, standing tall, my weight shifting subtly to my stronger leg. “Challenge me.”

The prisoner grinned, his fangs glinting in the dim light. “Don’t worry, Lord. I won’t disappoint.”

And then he vanished.

To the untrained eye, it might have seemed like teleportation, but I saw it clearly—the explosive burst of speed, the air rippling in his wake as he hurtled toward me at hypersonic velocity. For a mortal, it might have been impressive. For me, it was laughably slow.

I decided to humor him.

In an instant, I closed the distance between us, my movements effortless, almost lazy. My fist connected with his gut—a light tap, really—and he crumpled, blood spewing from his mouth like a grotesque fountain. The ground beneath him darkened as he staggered, clutching his stomach.

“What’s your power, opponent?” I asked, my tone almost conversational. I figured I might as well grant him the dignity of a final boast before ending him.

He glared up at me, blood staining his teeth as he spat out his answer. “I can steal a fraction of my opponent’s power.”

I couldn’t help but laugh. “Well, sorry about that. I don’t think I shared much.”

Before he could respond, I placed a hand on his shoulder, letting a trickle of my mana seep into his body. It was a gentle push, really—barely a fraction of a fraction of my true power. But for him, it was catastrophic.

His eyes widened in horror as his body began to convulse. Then, with a wet, visceral *pop*, he exploded. Organs and viscera scattered across the arena, painting the ground in a macabre mosaic.

I sighed, brushing a fleck of blood from my sleeve. “Bring the next one,” I called to the referee, my voice calm, almost bored.

The half-elf didn’t hesitate. He knew better than to waste time with announcements or formalities. This wasn’t a democracy, and it certainly wasn’t diplomacy. This was *me*—and I was in the mood for a fight.

The day dragged on, a monotonous parade of weaklings and fools. Prisoner after prisoner stepped into the arena, each one more pathetic than the last. Some tried to flee, others charged at me with desperate bravado, but the result was always the same—a burst of mana, a splash of blood, and another corpse added to the pile. By evening, the ground was a gruesome tapestry of gore, and I was no closer to feeling anything resembling satisfaction.

I sighed, wiping a speck of blood from my cheek as I left the arena. The sun dipped below the horizon, casting long shadows across the castle grounds. My steps echoed through the empty halls as I made my way to my study—a room I rarely visited but was maintained with meticulous care. The polished wooden floors gleamed, the air smelled faintly of cedar, and the massive oak desk sat like a throne at the center of the room.

I settled into the high-backed chair, its plush cushions molding to my form, and reached into my pocket. My fingers closed around a sleek black rectangle—a relic from a world long left behind. I pressed it twice, and it hummed to life, a faint glow emanating from its surface.

“Can the council hear me?” I asked, my voice calm but edged with authority.

The response came immediately, a chorus of voices speaking in unison—the Pentarchy. “Yes, we can.”

“Good,” I said, leaning back in my chair. “The Sixth Calamity has been averted. I’ll fix this world’s problems and then return. Make no mistake—this is not a request.”

There was a pause, a brief silence that spoke volumes. Then, the voices returned, subdued but compliant. “Understood.”

I ended the transmission, the rectangle dimming as I set it on the desk. My fingers drummed against the polished wood, the rhythmic tapping echoing in the stillness of the room. My thoughts drifted to my nation, to the people who relied on me, to the fragile peace I had fought so hard to maintain. I couldn’t leave—not yet. Not until I was certain they were safe.

The weight of my duty pressed down on me, heavier than any opponent’s blow. But it was a burden I bore willingly. For them, I would endure. For them, I would remain.

I rose from the desk, my reflection catching in the darkened window. The man who stared back was neither hero nor monster—he was something else entirely. Something beyond definition.

“Long live the Emperor,” I murmured that curse to myself.

The Unanticipated Fireball

Charlie's Perspective

I stood up from my desk, the weight of boredom still clinging to me like a second skin. Perhaps the gap in my knowledge of this world's evolving magic systems was to blame. After all, stagnation was the enemy of growth, and I had grown far too accustomed to the limits of my own power. It was time to learn something new.

I made my way to Liza's royal quarters, the halls of the castle silent save for the echo of my footsteps. Her door loomed ahead, ornate and imposing, but I didn't bother with formalities. A gentle tap was all it took.

The doors blasted open before I could finish knocking, revealing Liza in a deep bow. "My lord," she said, her voice tinged with reverence.

"Don't be so ceremonial," I said, tapping her head lightly to signal her to rise. "I'm here to learn. Teach me about compound magic."

Her eyes widened slightly, but she nodded, stepping aside to let me in. The room was a stark contrast to the rest of the castle—cluttered with scrolls, glowing crystals, and intricate diagrams of mana flow. Liza gestured for me to sit, but I remained standing, eager to dive in.

"Compound magic," she began, her voice steady and instructive, "is a system developed by humans. It's designed to work efficiently with smaller mana pools and lower skill levels. Since humans lack the innate magical prowess of other races, they've learned to compensate through teamwork. Multiple casters can synchronize their spells, amplifying their collective power. Unlike grand-sage magic, which revolves around a single dominant caster, compound magic thrives on coordination and unity."

She raised her hand, and I watched as her mana began to flow into the atmosphere. Strands of light wove together, forming a glowing circle that hovered in the air. She moved slowly, deliberately, allowing me to observe the intricate process of spellbinding.

“Analysis complete,” I said, activating my *Index of Magic*. The spell’s structure was clear to me now—simple yet elegant. I switched to my favorite title, *STRONGEST*, which granted me a 100% magic buff.

“Compound magic: Fireball,” I declared, raising my hand and pointing a finger gun toward the window. The desert stretched beyond, vast and serene, the perfect target for a harmless test.

But something went wrong.

“Level up completed,” flashed across my *Index of Magic*. I frowned, noticing a small but noticeable dip in my mana reserve. That shouldn’t have happened—my reserves were nearly infinite. A spell this basic shouldn’t have made a dent.

Then I looked outside.

A fireball the size of the moon loomed over the kingdom, its surface roiling with molten fury. The sheer scale of it was absurd, a testament to the overwhelming power I had inadvertently channeled.

“Liza!” I shouted, turning to her. “You were supposed to tell me that compound magic requires manual mana control!”

She blinked, her expression a mix of surprise and guilt. “I—I thought you knew, my lord. It’s basic knowledge for compound magic users.”

I groaned, pinching the bridge of my nose. The fireball was growing, its heat already distorting the air. I couldn’t absorb it—my *Grand Sage* title required me to release any spell I was holding before switching. There was only one option left.

I raised my hand again, this time with purpose. “Fire.”

The colossal fireball shot into the sky, a blazing comet that lit up the night like a second sun. It soared higher and higher until it vanished into the stratosphere, leaving behind a trail of shimmering embers.

I exhaled, lowering my hand. "Well, that was unexpected."

Liza stared at me, her mouth slightly open. "My lord, your level..."

I checked my *Index of Magic*. "Huh. Max level again. Guess I overdid it."

She shook her head, a faint smile tugging at her lips. "Only you, my lord, could turn a simple fireball into a celestial event."

I chuckled, leaning against the windowsill. "At least I learned something new. Next time, though, maybe start with the fine print."

Liza laughed, the sound light and genuine. "Noted, my lord."

As I gazed out at the desert, now bathed in the fading glow of the fireball, I felt a flicker of excitement. Perhaps this world still had a few surprises left for me after all. Yet I must learn how to control my new powers being a full blooded arch angel now I have no limit to power but a very vague idea of controlling it